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Motor: Gemini

Chapter 5: Obstruction

After Levi arrived at Grey Fortress, someone claiming to be the fortress quartermaster immediately sought him out.

"Respected Baron, I am Roland, the quartermaster of Grey Fortress. I have received notice that you are to head to Stormwind Territory, so I have already prepared the items you require. Would you like to inspect them now, my lord?"

Levi nodded. "Very well, let's go take a look. Clay, you all come along too!"

"Yes, my lord!"

Roland glanced at these knights and began to lead the way. "This way, Baron."

The quartermaster then led Levi to a campsite, where Levi smelled a foul stench from afar.

Upon entering the camp, what met his eyes was a scene of utter disarray, especially the gaunt serfs.

Quartermaster Roland pointed to these items and introduced them. "Baron, the items here have all been prepared for you in accordance with the Kingdom's regulations: 1,000 serfs, 200 tons of grain, 6 sets of iron armor, 50 sets of leather armor, 10 bows, 100 arrows, 50 longswords, 50 spears, 20 wooden shields, 20 plow oxen, and 30 pack horses. Additionally, we have equipped you with 50 elite soldiers, though you must pay their wages yourself—half a gold coin per person, per year."

Levi took a look and just sneered, saying nothing. However, Captain Clay, following behind, had veins bulging on his forehead, looking as if he were barely containing his rage.

"Are you sure this is the amount stipulated by the Kingdom's regulations? And what kind of junk is this that you've given us? Are you sure you didn't just pick this up from a garbage dump?"

The quantity of these items was clearly wrong, and the quality was abysmal—they were practically useless trash. The serfs were all elderly, weak, or women and children; there wasn't a single able-bodied man among them. As for those 50 'elite' soldiers, they were certainly 'elite'—there wasn't an ounce of meat on their bodies. There was no need to guess; someone was definitely playing tricks. This made Captain Clay extremely angry, as these supplies were also tied to the lives of their Knight Squad.

However, Quartermaster Roland still insisted that this was all there was and that he was merely following the rules.

Clay could no longer tolerate it; wasn't this just lying with eyes wide open? Just as he was about to explode with anger, he was stopped by Levi. Levi knew that this was clearly not something a mere

quartermaster would dare to do. Moreover, he was a Baron, a noble, yet neither the commander nor the deputy commanders of the Eighth Battalion had appeared. The reason was self-evident.

Thus, Levi grinned and looked at the quartermaster before him. "Lord Roland, did your commander or deputy commander prepare these things for me?"

"Huh? No, no, neither. I prepared this strictly according to the Kingdom's regulations."

Quartermaster Roland was thrown into a panic by Levi's sudden question, muttering inwardly, "Wasn't it said that this was just a pretty-boy Baron? Easy to fool? But this composure and insight—how is he easy to fool? Which bastard sent that intel over..."

Seeing that the quartermaster wanted to take responsibility himself, Levi smiled sinisterly. "Since it was truly prepared by you, Lord Roland, then please provide me with an inventory list—the kind that requires a signature and fingerprint! Surely you have heard: I am the newlywed husband of the Tulip Duchess. It is only because I offended my wife that I was exiled here. Therefore, everything I have actually belongs to the Tulip Duchess, including the supplies and population here, all of which need to be reported to her."

When Levi mentioned the Tulip Duchess, Quartermaster Roland became even more flustered. "Baron, no... this... there doesn't seem to be such a regulation..."

Roland naturally wouldn't sign it; otherwise, if the Tulip Duchess came looking for trouble, he would be finished.

Seeing the increasingly panicked quartermaster, Captain Clay also looked at Levi with surprise. He hadn't expected Baron Levi to have such methods; with just a few simple sentences, he had rendered this arrogant quartermaster unable to cope.

"Hmm, it seems you have your difficulties, Lord Roland. Then I won't make things difficult for you. I will accept these items, but I am not prepared to leave the fortress just yet, so I'll trouble you to keep them in your custody for the time being."

He then tossed out a gold coin. "Here, this is the storage fee. You must watch over them well, or your superiors will come looking for you." With that, he walked away with a smile.

"Ah! I have to keep them..." Quartermaster Roland held the gold coin, somewhat at a loss. "Did he accept them or not? How am I supposed to report this? Why do these big shots have to drag us little people into their fights?"

Roland lamented internally, then had to sigh. "Sigh, I'd better report it truthfully. This new Baron doesn't seem as stupid as the rumors suggested. Fortunately, he didn't see me as a threat."

On the way back, Clay was full of confusion. "My lord, why did you let that detestable quartermaster off the hook just now? And how could you say you accepted those things? Isn't that..."

"Hahaha, Captain Clay, when did I accept those things? Aren't they still in that warehouse? As for why I let that quartermaster go, because making things difficult for him is useless and would only waste energy. Moreover, our goal is simply to get the supplies we are entitled to; there's no need to make things too tense, as that wouldn't benefit us either. The current situation is just right—it won't make anyone look bad, and it's good to leave a way out for each other when the time comes," Levi explained with a smile.

"But why would they be willing to give them to us?"

"Hehe, that's even better. Didn't I say I wasn't leaving the fortress for now? So, if they don't prepare the supplies, we won't go to Stormwind Territory. Grey Fortress is safer anyway, isn't it? As for the deadline, that's not something they can control; that's a matter for the Royal Family and the Council of Nobles. If it causes an uproar at the Royal Capital because I didn't arrive at Stormwind Territory on time, then Lady Angelis will find out about all of this. Do you think they would allow Lady Angelis to find out about this matter?"

Clay's eyes lit up after hearing this. That's right; if it became a big deal, Lady Angelis would find out.

In fact, Levi had another purpose: waiting for his attribute points to increase. He already had 7 attribute points, and he only needed to wait another 15 days for Levi to be promoted to an official knight. By then, heading to Stormwind Territory would give him a higher capacity for self-preservation. Therefore, no matter what the other side did, Levi would delay things for a dozen days or so.

Subsequently, Levi and his group rented a large courtyard in Grey Fortress and settled down temporarily.